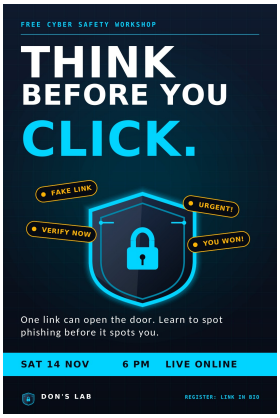
MASTERY PROJECT | AI FOR GRAPHIC DESIGN

AI-Assisted Design Project

Recreating and improving a brand identity system with AI: logo, poster and social media post for **DON'S LAB**



Final AI-enhanced logo: DON'S LAB





The logo applied to a poster and a social media post

Student	Don Philip
Programme	ALX Africa: AI for Graphic Design
Projects recreated	Activity: Logo Design with AI, Activity: Poster Design, Activity: Social Media Post
Brand	DON'S LAB, a cybersecurity learning lab
AI tool used	Claude (Anthropic): concept direction, copywriting, vector artwork generation and refinement

Contents

Part	What it contains
1. Original projects	First-pass versions of my logo, poster and social media post, with a critique of each
2. AI-enhanced versions	The refined logo, poster and social post as one consistent brand system
3. Process summary	How AI was used at each step, the prompts, and my decisions
4. Reflection	Strengths, limitations and potential of AI in my design workflow

Part 1: Original projects

I selected my three previous ALX design activities (Logo Design with AI, Poster Design and Social Media Post) and treated them as one brand project for **DON'S LAB**. The versions below are my **original first-pass concepts**: the first output of each activity, before refinement.



Original logo: “DP_SECURE”



Original poster



Original social post

Critique of the originals

- **Logo:** a flat, generic blue shield. The name “DP_SECURE” was hard to read and forgettable, the lettering was thin, and the mark had no depth or story.
- **Poster:** no visual hierarchy. The headline, shield and details were all centred at similar weight, there was no focal point, and nothing created urgency or emotion.
- **Social post:** mostly small text on a flat colour. It would not stop a scroll, the headline was generic (“Password Safety Tips”) and the call to action was weak (“Learn more”).
- **Across all three:** no shared colour palette, typography or logo usage, so they did not feel like one brand.

Part 2: AI-enhanced versions

A. Logo design

Brand statement. DON'S LAB is a cybersecurity learning lab that makes online safety simple, practical and free for students and everyday people. We believe protection should be understandable, not intimidating. Our tone is bold, tech-driven and trustworthy.

Concept exploration. I generated several directions with AI and compared them against the brand statement:



A: flat shield (original)



B: hexagon monogram



C: lock-in-letter wordmark



D: refined shield (chosen)

Why D was chosen. A shield with a lock communicates “protection” instantly. B read as a generic tech badge, and C was clever but did not scale down to an icon. I then refined D by hand-directing the proportions, stroke weights, bevel highlight and glow, and by adding circuit nodes to signal “technology”.

Versatility test (black, white and icon-only)



Black on white



White on black



Icon only (avatars, favicon)

Colour and type

Midnight #070B14	**Steel Navy** #1B2B47	**Signal Cyan** #00D4FF	**Alert Amber** #FFB400	**White** #FFFFFF
Backgrounds	Shield body, depth	Accent, links, CTAs	Warnings only	Headlines, body text

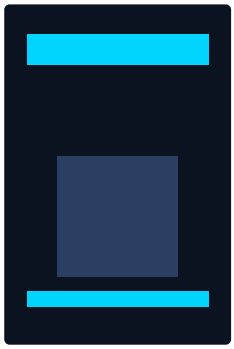
Headlines: DejaVu Sans Bold, wide and geometric with generous letter-spacing for a technical, futuristic feel. **Body:** Carlito, a clean, readable humanist sans. **Labels and data:** DejaVu Sans Mono Bold, which echoes code and terminals.

B. Poster design

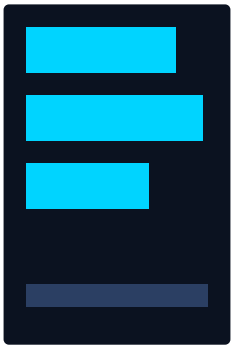
Design brief. Create a bold portrait poster that makes students and young professionals stop and think about phishing, and encourages them to join a free cyber safety workshop.

Audience and tone: students and early-career professionals; bold, urgent but friendly. After seeing it, people should feel a small jolt of caution and want to register.

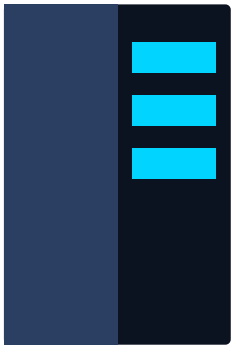
Layout concepts. I asked AI for three composition ideas and kept Concept A (strong central image with a bold headline) because it gave the clearest reading order.



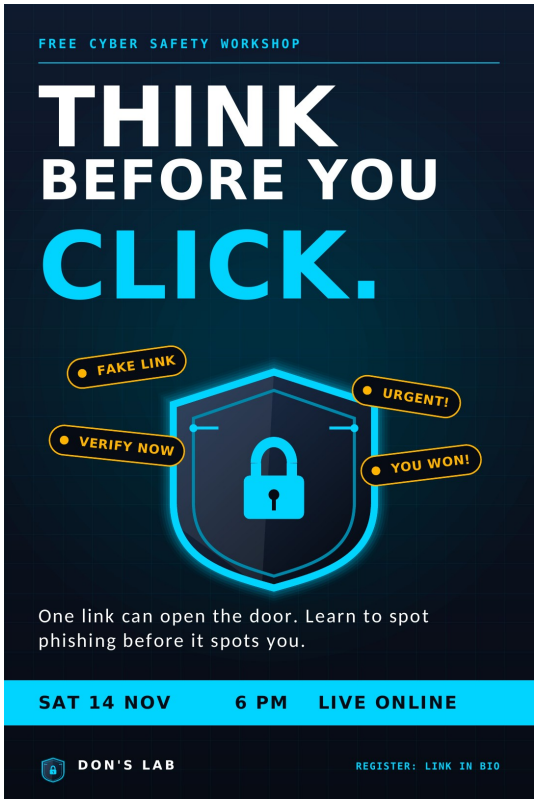
Concept A
central image + bold headline



Concept B
typography-led



Concept C
split layout



Final poster: how the design works

- **Hierarchy:** 1) the headline “THINK BEFORE YOU CLICK.”, 2) the shield blocking fake messages, 3) workshop details in a high-contrast bar.
- **Contrast:** white and cyan type on near-black; amber is reserved only for threats, so the eye separates danger from protection.
- **Repetition:** the shield, cyan accent and wordmark match the logo and social post.
- **Proximity and alignment:** every text block shares one left margin on a 60 px grid.
- **Text-to-image ratio:** the message can be read in about three seconds; supporting copy is two short lines.
- **Human edits:** I rewrote the AI headline options into one short command, cut extra copy, moved the threat chips closer to the shield and removed decorative arrows that cluttered it.

Final poster, 1080 x 1620 px (portrait), exported as PNG

C. Social media post

Design brief. Encourage students to join a free workshop by showing that a strong password protects them like a locked front door.



Final post, 1080 x 1080 px (Instagram square)

What I refined

- **Headline** (4 words, 3 lines): "Your password is your front door." It uses a familiar metaphor and reads at a glance.
- **Visual idea:** a password field and strength meter make the topic instantly recognisable.
- **CTA:** a high-contrast pill button, "Join the free workshop", plus "Link in bio".
- **Brand elements:** the logo lockup in the top-left corner and the same palette as the poster.

Caption (AI draft, edited in my own voice)

One weak password can undo everything. Make yours long, unique and never reused. Join our free cyber safety workshop and learn how to protect your accounts. Link in bio.
#CyberSecurity #OnlineSafety #StaySafeOnline #DonsLab

Mobile test checklist

- Headline is legible without zooming at phone size.
- Cyan on midnight passes strong contrast for text and buttons.
- Negative space around the headline keeps it from feeling crowded.
- Same colours, shield and wordmark as the poster, so it reads as one brand.

Part 3: Process summary

I treated AI as a creative assistant, not the designer. I set the goals, wrote the prompts, judged the results and decided what to keep. The AI tool used throughout was **Claude**, which generated concept ideas and copy, and produced the vector artwork that I reviewed and directed.

Stage	How AI was used	Example prompt (summary)	My decision
1. Brand definition	Helped turn my idea into a clear brand statement and tone.	“Dark, futuristic cybersecurity lab brand with a shield.”	Chose the name DON'S LAB, a dark theme and cyan accent.
2. Logo concepts	Generated several directions: flat shield, hexagon monogram, lock-in-letter wordmark.	“Create a dark 3D cybersecurity shield logo with the wordmark DON'S LAB.”	Rejected the first draft (DP_SECURE) as generic; shortlisted the shield.
3. Logo refinement	Adjusted depth, lettering, spacing and export.	“Make the lettering bolder and more futuristic.” “Give me a PNG.”	Kept bold, wide-spaced capitals and a clean silhouette; tested black, white and icon versions.
4. Poster	Suggested layouts, headline options and the “threat chips” idea.	“Portrait poster, strong central image, bold headline, phishing awareness.”	Picked Concept A, wrote a shorter headline, set hierarchy and grid, removed clutter.
5. Social post	Drafted layout, headline and caption.	“1080x1080 post, 3-7 word headline, strong CTA, same brand.”	Chose the front-door metaphor and password field; edited the caption.
6. Consistency check	Applied the same palette, type and logo across all pieces.	“Make all three pieces feel like one brand.”	Reviewed each piece for readability, contrast and brand fit.

What AI did and what I did

- **AI:** fast variations, copy options, consistent rendering of depth, glow and layout.
- **Me:** brand name and message, choosing between concepts, setting the visual hierarchy, simplifying, and rejecting anything generic or hard to read.

Part 4: Reflection on AI use

Strengths

- **Speed:** I could compare several logo, poster and post directions in the time one would normally take.
- **Visual polish:** depth, lighting and glow were rendered well beyond what I can do by hand today.
- **Iteration:** small prompt changes (name, lettering, mood) gave new versions without starting over.
- **Copy support:** headline and caption options helped me find a clearer voice.

Limitations

- **Text errors:** my first draft used a name I did not choose and had to be corrected; AI is unreliable with lettering.
- **Generic defaults:** “dark cyber shield” is a cliché, so I had to add distinctive choices (lock, circuit nodes, wordmark, amber threat chips).
- **Limited control:** precise spacing and alignment needed repeated, specific instructions.
- **No judgement:** AI cannot decide what suits my audience or what is too cluttered.
- **Originality:** because AI learns from existing work, I must check the logo is not too close to other brands and be open that AI was used.

Reflections on each activity

Logo: I kept the AI's strongest idea (shield + lock) but made it mine by choosing a clean silhouette, testing black-and-white versions and rejecting concepts that did not scale to an icon. **Poster:** AI inspired the layout, but the headline, hierarchy and decision to reserve amber for threats were design decisions I made. **Social post:** AI's suggestions pushed me towards a visual metaphor (the front door), while manual edits to copy length, spacing and the CTA made it feel like my brand.

Potential in my future workflow

I will use AI early, for moodboards, concepts and copy, and then take control for hierarchy, consistency and finishing. For final production I plan to rebuild key assets as clean vectors in a tool such as Figma or Illustrator. This project showed me that AI raises the speed and polish of my work, while the thinking that makes a design work (audience, message, clarity) still comes from me.

Key takeaway

AI is a powerful tool, not a replacement for design thinking. The best results came from clear briefs, honest evaluation and many small human decisions.